



A 10 meters long meteor just struck Earth

Scientists recently observed a meteor exploding over the Bering Sea with the energy of 10 atomic bombs. We never saw it coming. <https://digit.in/apr19-59>



Toyota, Japan's lunar rover

Toyota Motors to back JAXA with its fuel cell tech to power a manned, pressurised lunar rover. <https://digit.in/apr19-60>

app creator, game developer, or retail partner, Partner Center can help you reach more customers, provide greater service, and get help promoting and monetizing games.

5. **UWP:** Universal Windows Platform is an open source API to help develop apps that will run anything and everything from Microsoft. Be it Xbox Live, Xbox One, Windows PC, Hololens, without the need to re-write for each.

POST-PUBLISHING

So now after publishing the next part is managing and getting something out of your hard work. Now, the post publishing operations part is divided into four sub-categories: Monetize, Measure, Engage and Grow.

For each category Microsoft has their own lines of tools and they are quite helpful if you are a new developer or even if you are a developer with an existing set of games that you need help with.

Monetize

For monetizing the Game-Stack provides two tools, they are

1. **Microsoft Store:** The old and trusted Microsoft Store that is currently integrated with the entire Microsoft product line. This helps you to reach more customers and improve your productivity and promote and monetize your app.
2. **PlayFab Commerce:** PlayFab Commerce is the new tool in their arsenal. This comes integrated with the PlayFab Backend. PlayFab's in-game commerce system with features like receipt validation, targeted stores, player segmentation and commerce analytics allows you to boost revenue, engagement and retention.

Measure

If your game is published then monitoring and getting analytics out of it is a major hassle that you need to overcome. In any production grade software, getting the user analytics is a major component that you might

first need to address before going live. Microsoft Game-Stack provides you a lot of solutions on this frontier.

1. **Azure Gaming:** Azure Gaming comes with AI and Machine Learning capabilities that provide you the power to create a cloud based measurement tool so that you can monitor the players and get statistics out of their behaviour.
2. **PlayFab Analytics:** As we have said earlier, PlayFab is an heavy-duty component that provides you a lot of features. The analytics component gives you something more than the usual vanity metrics. There are fully actionable metrics and real-time data pipeline, data exchange dashboard and reports.
3. **Power BI:** If business intelligence is your domain then Power BI gives you that with the support of many powerful APIs. The data can be customized, extended and embedded in your application.
4. **Visual Studio App Center:** Visual Studio app center provides you the ability to monitor the health of your app and triage issues faster with live crash reporting, detailed diagnostics, and full stack traces. Integrate this data into PlayFab for even deeper insights on the player experience on your game and respond accordingly.

Engage

Engaging your customer in your games is another feature that developers are always looking for. Game-Stack comprises of three such tools to help you with this:

1. **Mixer:** Microsoft's Mixer is a direct competitor to Twitch where you have similar functionalities. This provides live-streaming of video capabilities, for console, PC or mobile with sub-second latency and unique interactive capabilities.
2. **PlayFab:** PlayFab also comes with an engagement module where it is used with LiveOps capabilities including live events, messaging, offers and promotions to engage your users.

3. **Xbox Live:** This is their old but pretty useful product from previous product lines. Xbox Live has quite a big customer base today and is growing rapidly. This gives the power to leaderboards, achievements, parties, clubs and cross-platform playing support for PC, mobile, console and the web for engagement when it comes to players for your game.

Grow

The last piece of the puzzle is growing your product and player base. Growth is needed for any software to succeed and for that Microsoft Game-Stack has quite a few products to help.

1. **Azure Gaming:** To handle the load as your game grows, Azure Gaming provides you the support to deploy the same across 54 data centers world-wide with support for China separately. This is currently more than any cloud provider. What it means is that you can easily scale and globalize your game without any hassle.
 2. **Mixer:** As we have discussed earlier Mixer is a platform for video streaming. Twitch made it big with game streaming and Mixer targets to do the same. Your game can be displayed to a huge amount of online users at once without thinking about the problems of creating an existing user base.
 3. **PlayFab:** PlayFab also provides a unique way to grow your customer base by providing specific experience to the user. PlayFab segmentation is also necessary if you want to provide a custom taste to a specific user base.
 4. **Xbox Live:** Xbox Live is a very vastly used product with more than 60 million active monthly online user. Comparing that with the other existing solutions that is quite respectable amount of user base. You can easily reach out to that many users without having a hassle.
- With Game Stack, Microsoft is trying to encourage developers to pick its services. In the end, will it work? 